

STEP DOCUMENT

LinkedIn-Feed Relevance & Job Trust

Title / Initiative	LinkedIn — Feed Relevance & Job Trust Revamp
Date & Version	20260815 – v1.0
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Prototype	ai.studio/apps/d262411f-970c-48dc-b535-dad3afdc472

STEP 1 DIVERGE

P0 Problem · Industry Watcher — Feed Irrelevance

Members who open LinkedIn to stay current on their industry land in a feed dominated by generic, promotional and engagement-bait content that isn't filtered for their field — so they scroll without reading, and quietly get their trend updates from X, Substack or Instagram instead.

- **Why this exists:** The feed ranks for broad engagement signals (likes, comments, shares) rather than topical relevance, and there is no dedicated, low-effort surface for “catching up” that sits apart from the algorithmic feed.
- **Opportunity:** Build a parallel, high-signal layer for quick catch-up — both social (network updates) and informational (industry news) — without rebuilding the core feed ranking algorithm.
- **Evidence (Phase 2 research):** 32% of users are dissatisfied with feed relevance; 80% scroll past most posts without reading; ~50% of users already learn about industry trends from an external app.

P0 Problem · Blocked Applicant — Job Trust & Search Precision

Job seekers can't tell whether a listing is real, can't quickly gauge if a company is trustworthy before applying, and lose time to blunt keyword search and dense job descriptions — pushing real search behaviour to Naukri, Indeed and Instahyre.

- **Why this exists:** Listings are self-reported with no independent verification layer, search is literal keyword-matching rather than intent-based, and JDs are long-form copy with no structured summary.
- **Opportunity:** Increase transparency and precision using verifiable signals (ratings, employee reviews, structured company facts) and AI (intent search, JD summarisation) — without requiring companies to change how they post jobs.
- **Evidence (Phase 2 research):** 35%+ named this their single biggest LinkedIn problem; 33% never hear back from recruiters; the majority have no reliable way to check company legitimacy.

Possible Solutions — Feed Irrelevance

Solution	Short description	Key assumption	Category
Status Bubbles	Story-style bubbles at the top of the Home feed showing quick updates from people the member follows or is connected to.	Users want a low-effort way to skim network activity without opening the full feed.	High Confidence—Built
LinkedIn AI Topic Highlights	Subscribable, AI-curated news rail (Top Pick, Tech, Finance, AI & Cloud, Design & UX) refreshed daily from LinkedIn's own data plus partner placements.	Users trust AI curation more than the algorithmic feed once it is clearly topic-scoped.	High Confidence—Built
LinkedIn AI Assistant	Conversational assistant inside Messaging that answers “what happened in my network / industry” on demand.	Users will proactively ask, rather than passively scroll, if the answer is fast and grounded.	Medium Confidence—Built
Daily / weekly digest notification	Push or email recap of the top items, delivered outside the app.	Users want the same information without opening the app.	Low Confidence
Follow / mute weighting overhaul	Let users explicitly weight which sources matter more, instead of relying on implicit algorithmic weighting.	Users will invest time manually tuning weights.	Low Confidence
“Focus Mode” feed toggle	A separate feed view, sorted by recency, restricted to followed topics and companies only.	Users want to opt out of the engagement-optimised feed entirely.	Moonshot
Community-curated trend boards	Reddit-style boards per topic, curated by users and moderators.	Community will self-moderate reliably at LinkedIn's scale.	Moonshot

Possible Solutions — Job Trust & Search Precision

Solution	Short description	Key assumption	Category
AI Intent-Based Job Search	Natural-language search bar that interprets role, salary band, location and remote intent in one query.	Users will type full sentences instead of keywords once they see it work.	High Confidence—Built
“Refine your search”	A conversational follow-up prompt that narrows the AI search results iteratively.	One search pass is rarely precise enough on the first try.	High Confidence—Built
Advanced Sort & Filter panel	Structured filters — salary, verified recruiter, easy apply, date posted — alongside the AI search bar.	Users want precision controls in addition to AI search, not instead of it.	High Confidence—Built
Company Trust Score & Verified Reviews	Aggregate rating, % would-recommend, verified employee reviews, and structured company facts (offices, industry, awards, official site).	Verified reviews are trusted more than open forums or no signal at all.	High Confidence—Built
AI-Generated JD Summary + “Ask about this job”	A structured summary at the top of every listing (pay, must-haves, skill match) plus a Q&A button for follow-ups.	Users abandon long job descriptions before finding what they need.	High Confidence—Built
Verified Recruiter badge & listing freshness	Identity-verify recruiters and auto-expire listings that go stale.	A verification pipeline can scale without heavy manual review.	Medium Confidence Fast-follow
Real-time Application Status Tracker	Visible pipeline status (Viewed / In review / Rejected) with SLA nudges to recruiters.	Recruiters will adopt a new, required workflow step.	High Impact, High Effort Roadmap (Phase 2)

STEP 2 CONVERGE — RICE PRIORITISATION

RICE Score — Feed Relevance candidates

Solution	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	RICE	Notes
Status Bubbles	3	2	3	1	18	Cheapest to ship; immediate engagement signal, low technical risk.
AI Topic Highlights	3	3	3	2	13.5	Core fix for the “feed is garbage” complaint; needs a curation + sponsorship pipeline.
AI Assistant	2	3	2	2	6	High potential impact; hallucination / accuracy risk keeps confidence down.
Daily / weekly digest	2	1	2	1	4	Deprioritised — risks notification fatigue.
Focus Mode toggle	2	2	2	3	2.7	Meaningful for power users only; heavy ranking-engine effort.
Follow / mute overhaul	2	2	1	3	1.3	Users unlikely to manually tune weights at scale.
Community trend boards	1	1	1	3	0.3	Moderation risk at scale; long build.

Chosen: Status Bubbles + AI Topic Highlights + AI Assistant (top 3 by RICE).

RICE Score — Job Trust & Precision candidates

Solution	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	RICE	Notes
Advanced Sort & Filter	3	2	3	1	18	Low effort; immediately reduces “blunt search” complaints.
AI JD Summary + Ask	3	2	2	1	12	Ships on top of existing JD content; some AI-accuracy risk.
AI Intent-Based Search	3	3	2	2	9	High reach & impact; intent-parsing confidence still maturing.
“Refine your search”	2	2	2	1	8	Pairs directly with AI search; low incremental effort.
Company Trust Score & Reviews	2	3	2	2	6	High impact on trust; needs a verified-review pipeline.
Verified Recruiter badge	2	2	2	2	4	Useful secondary signal; scheduled as a fast-follow.
Application Status Tracker	3	3	1	3	3	Solves the single highest-scored pain point (PIF 15) but needs a recruiter-side workflow change — lower confidence & higher effort this phase.

Chosen: Sort & Filter, AI JD Summary + Ask, AI Intent Search, Refine Search, Company Trust Score (top 5 by RICE).

Initiative-level sequencing

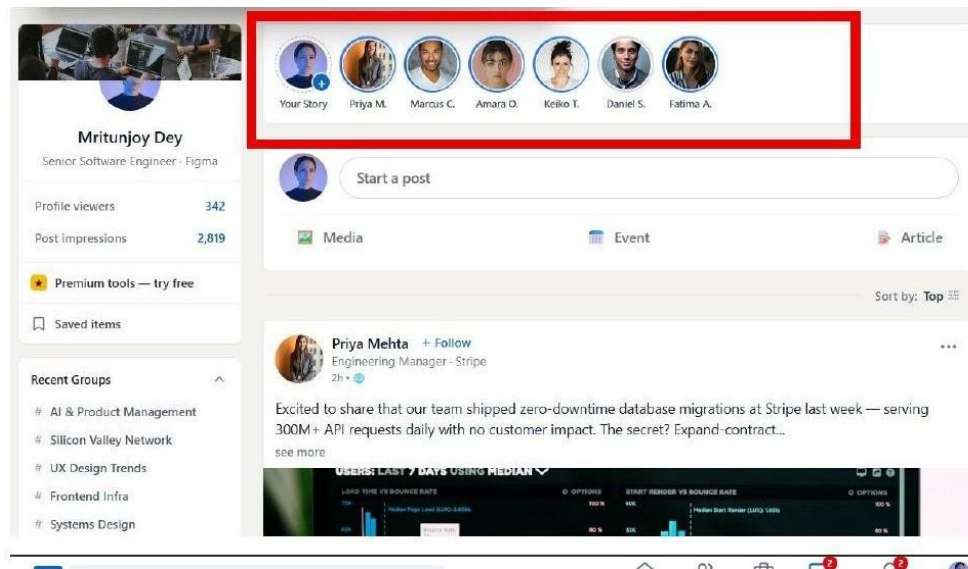
Initiative	Reach	Impact	Confidence	Effort	RICE	Sequencing
1. Feed Relevance & Discovery Suite	3	3	3	2	13.5	Primary — build first
2. Job Trust & Search Precision Suite	3	3	2	2	9	Secondary — build in parallel / next

Both suites ship in this revamp — they serve two distinct, high-value personas on the same product. RICE sets build sequence and engineering priority, not an either / or choice.

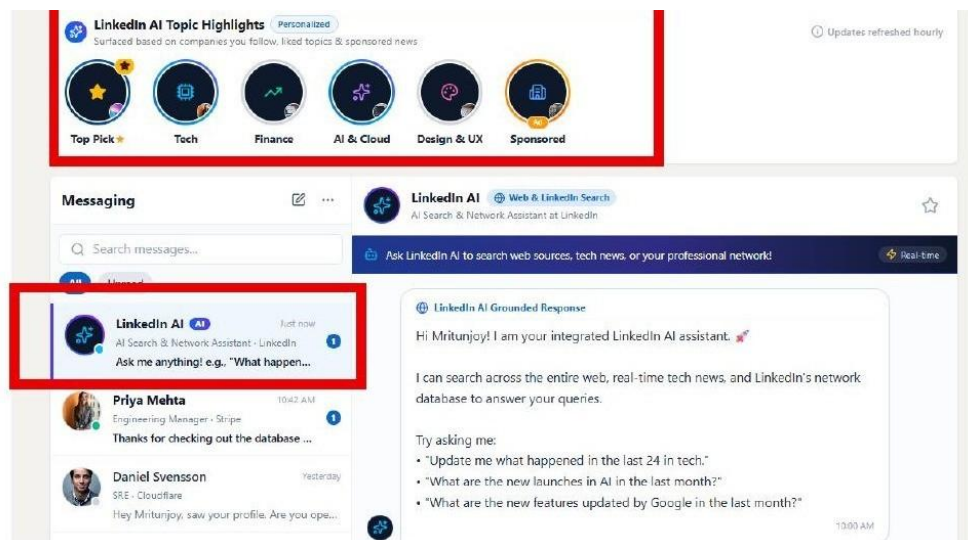
STEP 3 LIVE PROTOTYPE

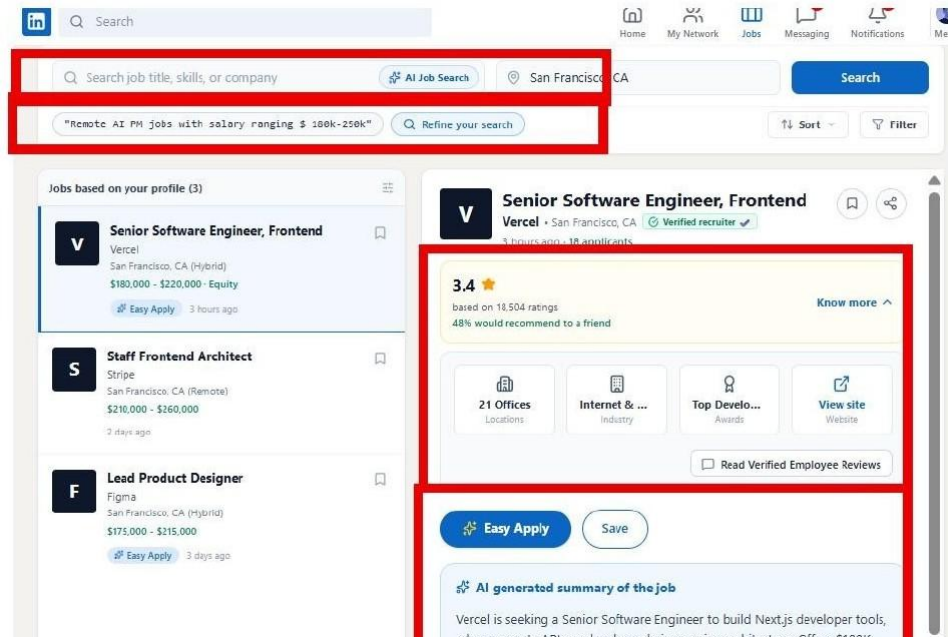
Prototype link:

<https://ai.studio/apps/d262411f-970c-48dc-b535-dad3afdcd472>



Home feed — Status Bubbles surface quick network updates above the post stream.





AI Job Search with Refine, Sort & Filter, Company Trust Score / Verified Reviews, and the AI-generated JD summary.

STEP 3 SUCCESS METRICS

Goal: “Increase time-well-spent on the feed and search-to-application confidence, without adding to feed clutter or job-search anxiety.”

Type	Metric	Definition	Why it matters
Key	Highlight / Bubble Engagement Rate	% of feed sessions where a user opens a Status Bubble or an AI Topic Highlight.	Directly measures whether the new surfaces replace passive, unrewarded scrolling.
Key	Search-to-Application Conversion	% of AI-assisted job searches that end in a submitted application.	Measures whether trust + precision features actually move people to apply.
Secondary	External Trend-App Reliance	Self-reported (survey) share of users who still go to X / Substack / Instagram for industry trends.	Tracks whether we are winning back the “stay current” job-to-be-done.
Secondary	Time to First Relevant Result	Avg. time from search entry to first Save / Easy Apply.	Measures whether intent search + filters reduce blunt-search friction.
Guardrail	Core Feed Scroll Depth / Time in Feed	Should not decrease.	Ensures new surfaces add value without cannibalising core feed engagement.
Guardrail	Recruiter Listing Volume	Should not decrease.	Ensures trust features don't add so much friction that legitimate recruiters leave.

STEP 3 PITFALLS & MITIGATION

Assumption at risk	Failure mode	Impact	Likelihood	Mitigation
AI Topic Highlights feel organic and trustworthy	Users can't tell AI curation apart from paid placements and feel misled.	High	Medium	Clear “Sponsored” labelling (in prototype), cap sponsored share per category, monitor mislabelling complaints.
AI Assistant answers are accurate	Assistant hallucinates a trend or misattributes a network update.	High	Medium	Ground answers in retrieved sources with citations, show an “AI can make mistakes” notice, log low-confidence answers.

Assumption at risk	Failure mode	Impact	Likelihood	Mitigation
Company Trust Score reflects reality	Review-gaming (fake positive or negative reviews) skews scores.	High	Medium	Require verified employment history to review, rate-limit reviews per account, run anomaly detection on review velocity.
AI JD Summary is faithful to the source posting	Summary omits or misstates a requirement; applicant or company is misrepresented.	Medium	Medium	Always show "View full description," flag summaries built on incomplete JDs, allow one-tap reporting of inaccurate summaries.
Trust + precision fixes are enough on their own	Ghost-job frustration persists because applicants still hear nothing back after applying.	Medium	High	Scope the Application Status Tracker explicitly as the next roadmap item; say so in release notes so expectations are set.